

Customer Feedback Summary: One Term of Trading

Summary of 120 customer feedback responses (104 with comments) collected across an 11-week teaching term at the stall. Average rating 3.2 out of 5, dipping below 2.8 in weeks 5 to 8 as queue and sell-out complaints peaked, recovering to about 4 by the end of term.

Themes, ranked

- Queues and waiting time: 34 comments (31%). Lunchtime waits of 15 to 25 minutes; customers report walking away and defecting to competitors.
- Price and value: 22 comments (20%). Split roughly evenly between “too dear for every day” and “fair for fresh”.
- Sold out by early afternoon: 19 comments (17%). Trays empty by 13:00 most days; gluten-free stock gone by late morning.
- Dietary and allergens: 14 comments (13%). Requests for gluten-free volume, vegan options and visible allergen labelling.
- Payment: 9 comments (8%). Card machine reliability and a cash-only day caused friction and lost sales.
- Location and hours: 7 comments (6%). Requests for earlier opening, Fridays, and better signage.
- Praise with nothing actionable: 5 comments (5%).

The one thing to fix

Queues and sell-outs are the same capacity problem seen from two ends; together they account for 48 per cent of all comments. Any intervention that smooths the lunch spike (pre-ordering, pickup slots, a live sold-out board) attacks both.

Fictional teaching material for the AI in the Workplace workshop, Cardiff University.